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AI BLOG FACTORY

THE PROMPT ENGINEERING PLAYBOOK

How to Get Perfect Answers from AI Every Time

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Before You Start

This isn't about AI hype. It's about results.

I wrote this because I was tired of getting vague, useless answers from ChatGPT. Every student I knew was doing the same thing: typing questions like they were Google searches and wondering why the output felt shallow.

Then I learned to ask better.

The difference between a lazy prompt and a crafted one is the difference between a generic answer and one that saves you hours. This book teaches you exactly how to do that — fast, practical, no theory required.

Here's what I need from you: actually try the prompts. Don't just read them. Copy one into ChatGPT right now and see what happens.

Ready? Let's build your prompt muscle.

— Joy Roy, AI Blog Factory

Why 90% of Prompts Fail

Understanding the gap between what you type and what AI hears.

Here's the uncomfortable truth: most students treat AI like a search engine. They type something vague, get a mediocre answer, and blame the tool.

The tool isn't the problem. The prompt is.

The Google Habit That's Killing Your AI Results

When you Google 'photosynthesis,' you want the top result. When you ask AI 'explain photosynthesis,' you get a 500-word essay that could be an article, a textbook chapter, or a Reddit answer. You don't know which because you didn't say.

AI doesn't read your mind. It reads your words. Every vague word is a slot the AI fills with assumptions — usually wrong ones.

|| I spent 20 minutes re-prompting ChatGPT until I realized the problem wasn't ChatGPT — it was me. I wasn't telling it what I actually wanted.

— Rohan, 2nd Year CS

This You Type	What AI Hears
"Tell me about ML"	Generic ML overview, any depth, any format
"Explain ML to a first-year student with examples"	Targeted intro, accessible language, concrete examples
"Help me with my assignment"	Hundreds of possible assignments, no context
"I'm writing a 500-word essay on supervised vs unsupervised learning"	Exact topic, format, length, audience

TIP: THE FIX

Add THREE things to every prompt that's not working:

1. Who you are (student, year, subject)
 2. What format you need (list, essay, code, comparison)
 3. How long it should be (sentences, pages, bullet points)
-

The CORELITE System

The 7-part framework that turns any question into a perfect prompt.

Stop memorizing prompt templates. Instead, learn the anatomy of a good prompt. CORELITE gives you seven elements to mix and match. You don't need all seven every time — but knowing them means you always know what to add.

C — Context

Background. Where are you? What course? What semester?

Example: 'I'm a third-year engineering student studying thermodynamics.'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

O — Objective

What specific outcome do you want?

Example: 'I need to understand the first law well enough to solve exam problems.'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

R — Response format

Essay? Code? Bullet points? Step-by-step?

Example: 'Give three real-world examples and one formula application.'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

E — Examples

Show AI what good output looks like.

Example: 'Like this: [paste a similar answer you liked].'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

L — Length

50 words or 500? One paragraph or a full page?

Example: 'In under 150 words.'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

I — Intent

Why do you need this? Studying? Assignment? Curiosity?

Example: 'I'm preparing for a midterm in 3 days.'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

T — Tone

Academic? Casual? Humorous? Serious?

Example: 'Keep it conversational but accurate.'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

E — Edge cases

What should NOT be included?

Example: 'Don't include calculus-level math.'

— Add this element when your output feels incomplete

TIP: PROMPT FORMULA

Context + Objective + Response Format covers 80% of situations.

Add Examples and Edge cases for complex or technical work.

Full CORELITE Example

I am a third-year mechanical engineering student [CONTEXT]
studying thermodynamics [CONTEXT - specific topic].

I need to understand the first law of thermodynamics [OBJECTIVE]
well enough to solve exam-style problems [OBJECTIVE - specific need].

Give me three real-world examples and one formula walkthrough [FORMAT]
in under 300 words [LENGTH].

Keep it conversational but accurate [TONE].
I am studying for a midterm in three days [INTENT].
Do not include calculus-level derivations [EDGE CASE].

Five Prompt Patterns That Always Work

Copy these structures once. Use them forever.

Patterns are more useful than individual prompts because they work across subjects. Learn these five and you'll never be stuck.

PATTERN 1: The Expert Role-Play

Best for: Getting explanations from a specific perspective.

Formula: 'Act as a [role]. Explain [topic] to [audience].'

Example: 'Act as a patient physics professor. Explain quantum entanglement to a first-year student using only analogies.'

PATTERN 2: Chain-of-Thought

Best for: Complex problems that need step-by-step reasoning.

Formula: Add 'Let's think step by step' or 'Explain your reasoning before giving the answer.'

Improvement: 40%+ accuracy boost on technical problems.

PATTERN 3: Few-Shot Examples

Best for: When you want output in a specific style or format.

Formula: Give 2-3 examples of the output you want, then ask.

Example: 'Here is an example of the format I want: [example]. Now do the same for [your topic].'

PATTERN 4: The Iterative Refine

Best for: Starting broad and narrowing down.

Round 1: Get a general answer.

Round 2: 'Go deeper on [specific point].'

Round 3: 'Give me a real example of that.'

Most students never go to Round 3. That's where the gold is.

PATTERN 5: The Debate Mode

Best for: Understanding both sides of an argument.

Formula: 'Argue for [position A]. Then argue against it from [position B].'

Perfect for essay prep, critical thinking, understanding trade-offs.

The 50-Prompt Library

Ready-to-copy prompts organized by use case. Modify. Send. Done.

These are your training wheels. Use them as-is until you internalize CORELITE, then start building your own.

FOR STUDYING

- Explain [topic] as if I am 15 years old. Use one analogy.
- Give me 5 exam-style questions on [topic] with answers.
- Quiz me on [topic]. Ask questions one at a time. Grade me.
- Create a one-page cheat sheet for [topic].
- What are the 3 most misunderstood concepts about [topic]?
- Turn these notes into flashcards: [paste notes]

FOR WRITING

- Suggest 5 thesis statements for an essay on [topic].
- Outline a 1000-word essay on [topic] with 4 sections.
- Improve this paragraph's clarity while keeping my voice: [paste]
- Give me 3 transition sentences between these ideas: [list]
- Write an introduction that hooks the reader in 2 sentences.

FOR CODING & TECH

- Explain this error in simple terms: [paste error]
- Write a [function/algorithm] in [language] with comments.
- Review my code and suggest 3 improvements: [paste]
- What does this code do? [paste code]
- Convert this [language A] code to [language B]: [paste]

FOR RESEARCH

- Find 5 key papers on [topic] from the last 2 years.

- Summarize the main arguments for and against [position].
- What are the biggest gaps in research on [topic]?
- Create a comparison table of [concept A] vs [concept B].

FOR PRODUCTIVITY

- Create a study schedule for [exam] in [X] days.
- Prioritize these tasks for a student: [list tasks]
- Write a professional email asking [request].
- Summarize this in 3 bullet points: [paste text]

Debugging Bad Answers

When the output is wrong, here's exactly what to fix.

Even with bad prompts, you can fix the output. This chapter teaches you to diagnose and repair.

Too Generic?

Add specifics. Name the subject, your level, the exact question you need answered. 'Help me with math' becomes 'Help me understand integration by parts for my Calculus 2 midterm'.

Too Long?

Add length constraints. 'In 3 bullet points.' 'Under 100 words.' 'One paragraph only.' AI defaults to verbose.

Wrong Tone?

Name the tone you want. 'Explain to a peer.' 'Be formal and academic.' 'Make it conversational.' One word changes everything.

Wrong Depth?

Name your level. 'I'm a beginner.' 'I know the basics but need advanced.' 'Give me expert-level detail.'

Seems Made Up?

Ask for sources. 'Cite your sources.' 'What paper is this from?' 'Can you verify this claim?'

Wrong Format?

Be painfully specific. 'A comparison table with 3 columns.' 'Numbered steps.' 'A decision tree.'

TIP: QUICK FIX

When a bad answer appears, don't re-prompt from scratch. Say: 'That's not quite what I meant. [Fix one thing].' Small corrections work better than complete rewrites.

Quick-Copy Prompt Sheet

Print this page. Stick it on your wall. Never write a bad prompt again.

These are the 10 most versatile prompts. Memorize the structures, not the words.

1. EXPLAINER: 'Explain [topic] to a [year]-year student with 2 examples and 1 analogy.'
2. ESSAY HELP: 'Outline a [X]-word essay on [topic] with [N] sections and a thesis statement.'
3. CODE FIX: 'I got this error as a beginner: [error]. My code: [code]. Explain simply how to fix it.'
4. STUDY SESSION: 'Quiz me on [topic] – 10 questions, increasing difficulty. Grade each answer.'
5. FLASHCARDS: 'Create 15 flashcards from: [paste notes/topic]. Q: [question] A: [answer].'
6. COMPARISON: 'Compare [A] and [B] in a table with columns: feature, pros, cons, best for.'
7. EMAIL: 'Write a polite email to [person] about [request]. Keep it under 100 words.'
8. SUMMARIZE: 'Summarize this in [X] words covering: [key points]. [paste text/content].'
9. DEBATE: 'Argue for [position]. Then argue against it. Which is stronger and why?'
10. CREATIVE: 'Give me 10 creative ideas for [project/presentation/video] about [topic].'

YOU NOW HAVE THE SYSTEM.

The only thing standing between you and excellent AI output is a better prompt. You now know how.

Keep this book open while you work. Copy prompts directly. Modify them for your subjects. Build your own library.

Share it with a friend who's still typing questions into ChatGPT like they're Google searches.

TIP: REMEMBER

Bookmark the Quick-Copy Prompt Sheet. It's the last page. Use it daily for 2 weeks and you'll never write a bad prompt again.